

slightly past the stock market of 1942, horror films featured Frankenstein monsters, vampires, werewolves and undead mummies.

As the bull market in stocks resumed in the early 'Forties, Hollywood abandoned dark, foreboding themes in the most sure-fire way: by laughing at them. When Abbott and Costello met Frankenstein, horror went out the door.

The next 25 years treated moviegoers to a varied fare as horror themes were muted. All the while, the bull market in stocks rolled on. Immediately following the speculative bull market peak in December 1968, however, the cinematic mood changed.

How far that change had carried did not become fully clear until 1970, when the flesh-eating zombies of *Night of the Living Dead* began packing them into the movie houses. Just look at the chart of the Dow and you'll see the crash in mood which inspired that movie and desire to see it. Then, in 1974, as the dark mood deepened, *The Texas Chainsaw Massacre* premiered and explicit gore was introduced as a horror movie staple.

*Art expressing a light, right, positive mood is
dominant when stocks are in bull markets . . .*

For its part, pop music has been strikingly in tune with the Dow Jones Industrial Average. The ups and downs of the careers of leading youth-oriented pop musicians have eerily paralleled the peaks and troughs in the stock market. At turns in share prices, the dominant popular singers and groups have faded quickly into obscurity, to be replaced by styles that reflected the newly emerging mood.

The 'Twenties bull market featured jazz and ultimately hyper-fast dance music. The 'Thirties bear years brought hard-time laments and mellow ballroom dance music. With the mid-'Thirties bull market came free-wheeling swing